

DIGITAL LITERACY

CSE 0001

Project Report

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Date: 30th March, 2026

Introduction

As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, I have developed this Digital Literacy Portfolio to serve as a comprehensive educational resource for my peers.

The primary objective of this project is to navigate and master essential digital landscapes—ranging from professional networking and technical collaboration to cybercrime awareness and formal communication.

This report documents five distinct tasks that demonstrate my ability to operate safely and professionally in the digital world, while providing a practical roadmap for others to follow. By completing these modules, I have strengthened my own digital footprint and gained the practical skills necessary to help my batchmates navigate the complexities of our increasingly digital academic and professional environments.

TASK 1 : Digital Literacy Infographic

For this assignment, I designed a vertical **poster (A4 format)** using **Canva (canva.com)** to serve as an awareness resource for first-year B.Tech students. The design focuses on defining Digital Literacy and providing actionable guidance across three critical areas: safe internet use, building a professional online identity, and leveraging digital collaboration tools effectively.

The infographic, titled "DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS | A STUDENT'S GUIDE," uses modern flat illustrations, clear icons, and a cohesive color palette of professional blues and greens with distinct sections. It defines Digital Literacy as combining technical and cognitive skills for finding, evaluating, and creating information. The design then breaks down complex topics into simple visual points: "Safe Internet Practices" (spotting scams, strong passwords), "Professional Online Presence" (maintaining clean profiles, showcasing skills), and "Useful Digital Tools for Students" (using Google Workspace and e-learning platforms). The goal was to create an encouraging, professional visual that feels accessible to peers while reinforcing the importance of being a responsible Student Digital Ambassador.

The most **interesting** part of the process was discovering how vast and powerful Canva's library of design assets and infographic templates are. It made it possible to translate complex technical concepts into simple, engaging visuals, which would have been significantly more challenging if I were attempting to design from scratch without visual tools. Condensing large amounts of research into concise bullet points that still conveyed the necessary depth of information was also a useful exercise in visual communication and clarity.

TASK 2: Student Digital Portfolio

To establish a strong professional foundation, I have created my foundational portfolio on LinkedIn, GitHub, and ResearchGate. Each serves a distinct purpose in my growth in these four years, and beyond.

LinkedIn will be for developing and expanding my professional network. I will use it to connect with established experts in my field, as well as to engage with a community of like-minded individuals, share project updates, and stay informed on market trends. Over the next four years, I plan to expand my professional network, and document my internships and certifications.

GitHub functions as my technical portfolio. It is where I shall keep and host my projects, contribute to open-source projects, and work on collaborative projects. My roadmap involves maintaining consistency on the platform, eventually hosting full-scale applications and collaborating on global repositories.

ResearchGate will serve as my academic hub for scientific discovery. I will use it to follow scholarly publications and connect with researchers in the bioengineering domain. Given my interest in research and development, I plan to use this platform over the next four years to follow the work of leading institutions and eventually share my own undergraduate research findings. By integrating these three platforms, I will create a holistic professional presence that demonstrates both my technical competence and my commitment to academic excellence.

TASK 3: Explore Coding and Collaboration Platforms

For my technical development, I have been practising questions on HackerRank, a competitive programming platform designed to sharpen one's problem solving skills through programming. I used this environment to build a consistent practice routine, specifically focusing on Python language. By solving a variety of challenging questions, ranging from basic data types to conditional and iterative problems, I successfully achieved 2-stars in Language Proficiency through Python.

This hands-on practice has been instrumental in bridging the gap between theoretical studying and practical implementation. Academically, this platform serves as a vital resource, as it helped me get practical hand on practise of programming, instead of just acquiring bookish knowledge. I was more compelled to obey the syntax, which often get neglected in theoretical studying.

Moving forward, I plan to continue HackerRank, getting 5-stars in both Language Proficiency and Problem solving, and also start to master additional languages like C++, ensuring a versatile academic foundation and maintaining practical skills.

TASK 4: Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

In this task, I practiced essential professional correspondence by drafting a formal extension request to a professor and a summer internship application to ImmunoACT. I also developed a social media guide to help my peers maintain a responsible digital footprint.

A scenario where poor digital communication caused a significant problem involves a student sending an overly casual email to a professor using text-speak and no subject line. This led to the request being ignored, resulting in a missed deadline and academic penalty. To prevent this, the student should have used a formal salutation and a structured body, as I demonstrated in my own email drafts. Additionally, posting impulsively on social media can damage one's professional reputation. This task taught me that professional maturity is reflected in every digital interaction, and clear, respectful communication is vital for career success.

TASK 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

Guide

While researching identity theft for this task, I was genuinely shocked by the scale of the issue. Seeing that over **1.1 million cases** were reported in just one year highlights how vulnerable regular users are in the digital landscape. The case study of Sarah was particularly eye-opening; it demonstrated that the impact isn't just a one-time financial loss, but a grueling **18-month process** of legal battles and emotional distress to restore one's credit and identity. This taught me that the consequences of a single lapse in judgment can last for years.

As a result, the one habit I am changing immediately is my lax approach to password security. I have started using a **password manager** to ensure every account has a unique, complex password of at least 12 characters. Furthermore, I am committing to **avoiding public Wi-Fi** for any sensitive tasks like UPI payments or accessing my college portal, switching instead to mobile data to ensure my connection remains private.